ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 31

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Malay Jawi Alphabet

حروف جاوي ڤرتام واي

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 37 Jawi Letters of Malay with English Phonetics

ا ب ت چ غ ڤ

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Malay Jawi Alphabet — حروف جاوي ڤرتام ساي

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 31

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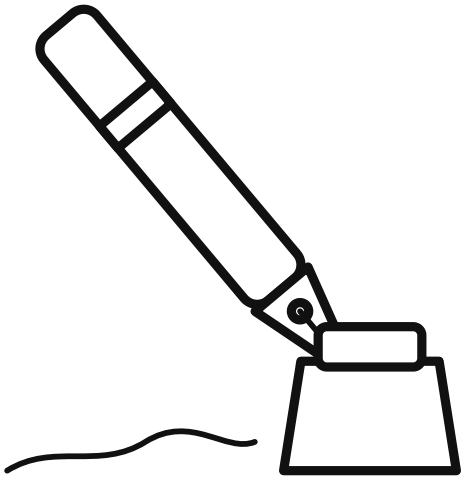
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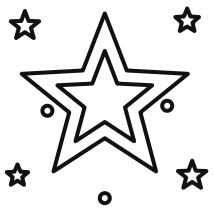
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



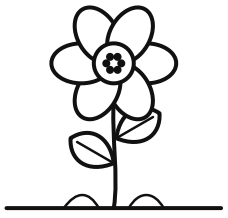
This book belongs to

بوکو این میلیق

I started learning Malay on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 31 is Malay. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Jawi is read from right to left**, like the Qur'an. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **The line under each word is its Rumi spelling** — Malay in Latin letters. Rumi is easy to read aloud: *a* as in "father", *i* as in "see", *u* as in "put", and *e* is usually a short 'uh' (as in "about").
- In Rumi, **c** says 'ch' (*cawan* = "chah-wan"), **sy** says 'sh', **ng** is the sound in "sing" and **ny** is the sound in "canyon".
- **Some letters sound the same** in Malay (ص س ث all say *s*; ظ ز ذ all say *z*). They keep their Arabic spelling, which helps when children later read the Qur'an.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Malay name** written in Malay (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. Because Jawi letters **change shape** when they join, the third box shows the letter at the start, middle and end of a word (letters that never join to the next letter are marked).

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Malay as written in Malaysia and Brunei.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Malay! بهاس ملايو

bahasa Melayu — the Malay word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **80 million people** speak Malay as a first or second language, and Indonesian, a form of Malay, is spoken by many millions more.[3]

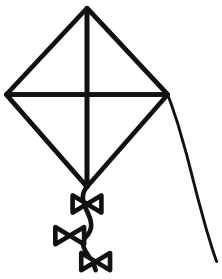
Where?
In **Malaysia**, **Brunei**, **Singapore** and **southern Thailand**, and by families around the world.

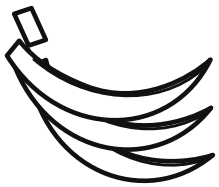
How is it written?
Malay has two scripts: **Rumi** (Latin letters) and **Jawi**, an Arabic-based script written from **right to left**. Jawi has been used for Malay for hundreds of years.

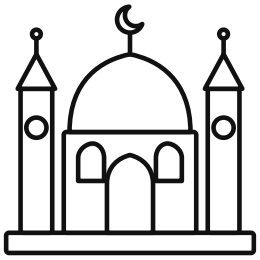
How many letters?
This book teaches **37 Jawi letters**: the Arabic letters plus six made for Malay sounds — چ غ ڤ ک ۏ ڽ.

Where can you see Jawi?
On mosques, school books and religious lessons, on street signs in some states, and in Brunei, where Jawi is written alongside Rumi.

A friend of the Qur'an
Many Malay words come from Arabic: مسجد *masjid* (mosque), علمو *ilmu* (knowledge). Knowing Jawi helps with reading the Qur'an.







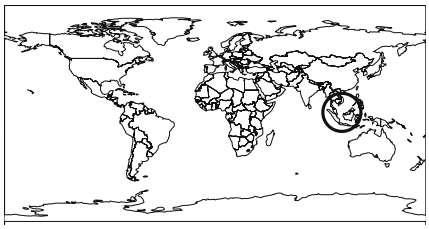
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Malay Alphabet حروف جاوي

37 letters – حروف جاوي

ح *ḥa*	ج *jim*	ث *sa*	ة *ta marbutah*	ت *ta*	ب *ba*	ا *alif*
س *sin*	ز *zai*	ر *ra*	ذ *zal*	د *dal*	خ *kha*	چ *ca*
غ *ghain*	ع *ain*	ظ *ẓa*	ط *ṭa*	ض *dad*	ص *sad*	ش *syin*
ل *lam*	ک *ga*	ک *kaf*	ق *qaf*	ڤ *pa*	ف *fa*	ڠ *nga*
ي *ya*	ء *hamzah*	ه *ha*	ۏ *va*	و *wau*	ن *nun*	م *mim*
					ڽ *nya*	ى *alif maksurah*

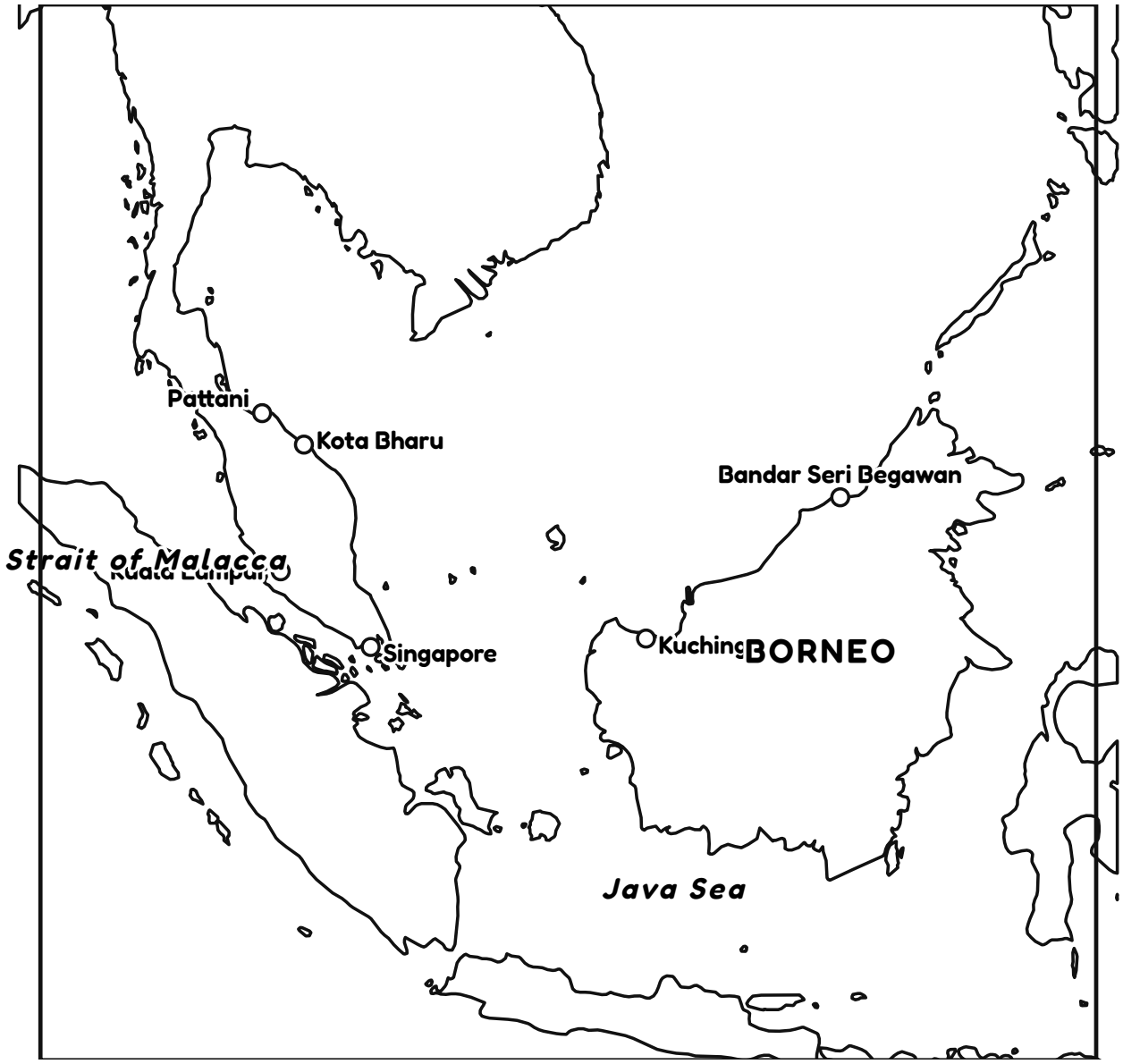
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Malaysia, Brunei and Singapore on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Malay spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Malay is spoken in Kuala Lumpur and Kota Bharu (Malaysia), Kuching on the island of Borneo, Bandar Seri Begawan (Brunei), Singapore and Pattani (southern Thailand).

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The Letters حروف جاوي

huruf Jawi — “the Jawi letters”

Jawi is written **from right to left**. Open your book at any letter page and start reading on the right!

Arabic letters, plus six more

Jawi uses the Arabic letters and adds six of its own for Malay sounds:

چ c غ ng ڤ p ک g ۏ v ڽ ny

Letters hold hands

Most letters **join** to the letter after them and change shape a little:

ب + و + ل + ن = بولن

b + u + l + n = bulan (moon)

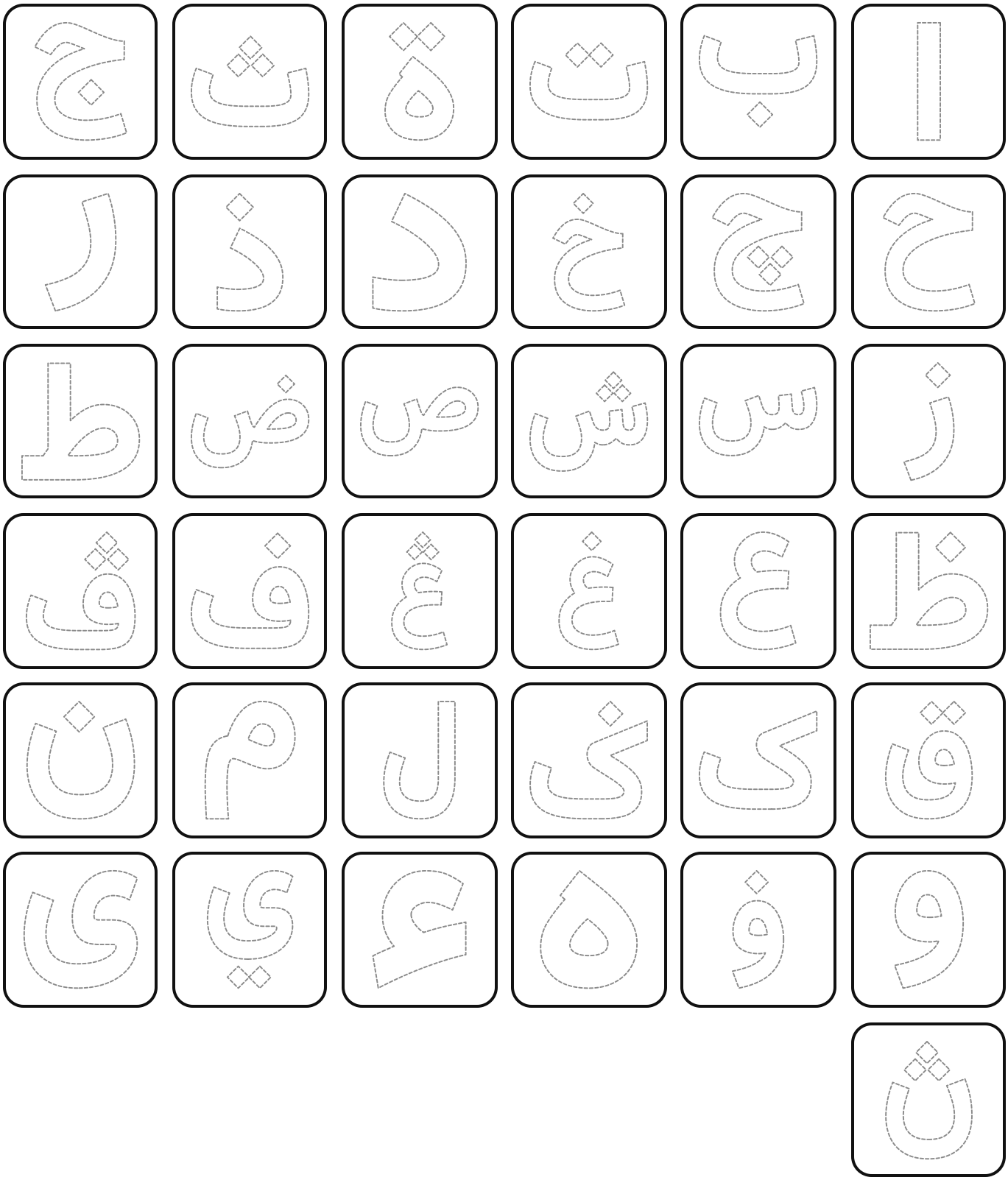
Two ways to write Malay

Malay is also written in Latin letters, called **Rumi**. Under every Jawi word in this book you will find its Rumi spelling: بولن = *bulan*.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters حروف جاوي

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ا

NAME · نام

اليف

alif

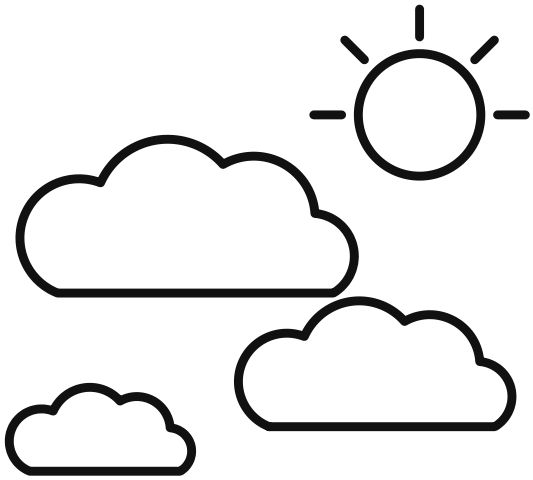
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”; at the start of a word it can also carry ‘e’, ‘i’ or ‘u’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ا · after a letter ـا

It never joins to the letter after it.



ا IS FOR

اون

awan

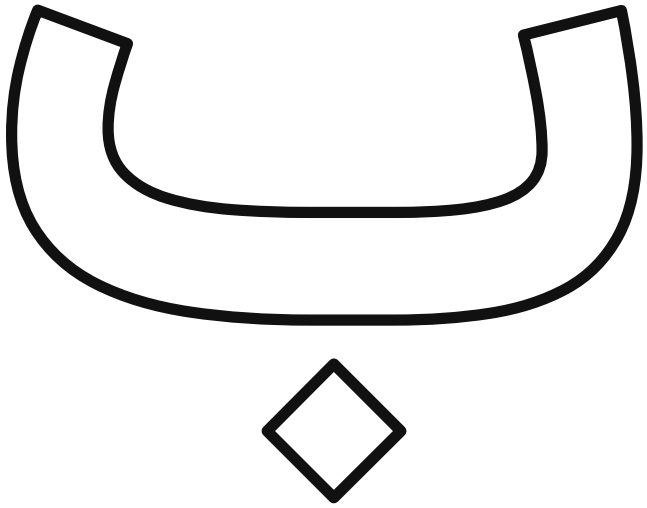
cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ا ا ا ا ا ا

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NAME · نام

با

ba

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

بـ ـبـ ـب

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

One dot below.



ب IS FOR

بولن

bulan

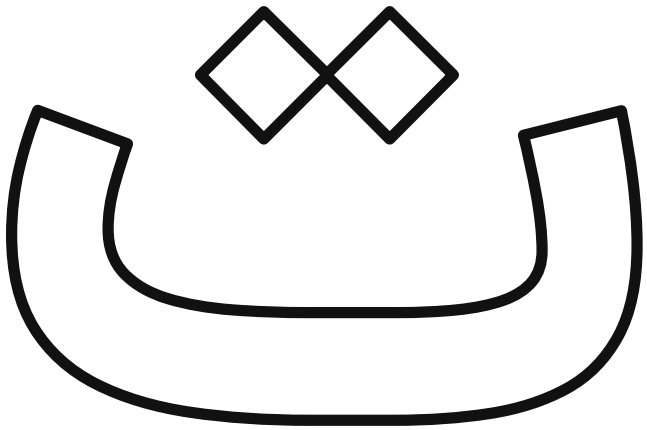
moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ب ب ب ب

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NAME · نام

تا

ta

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

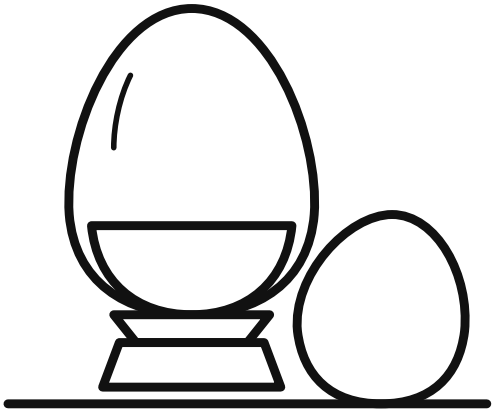
‘t’ as in “top”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

تـ ـتـ ـت

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Two dots above.



ت IS FOR

تلور

telur

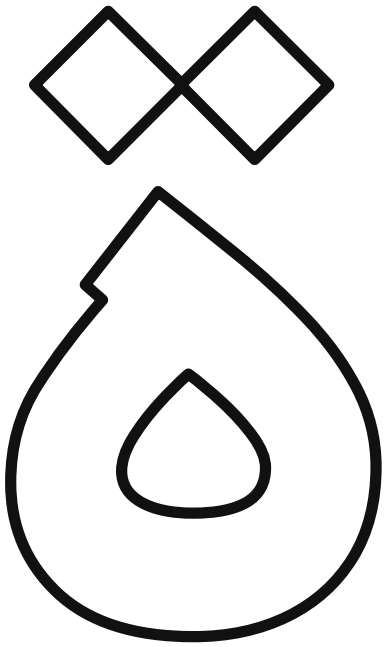
egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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NAME · نام

تا مربوطة

ta marbutah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

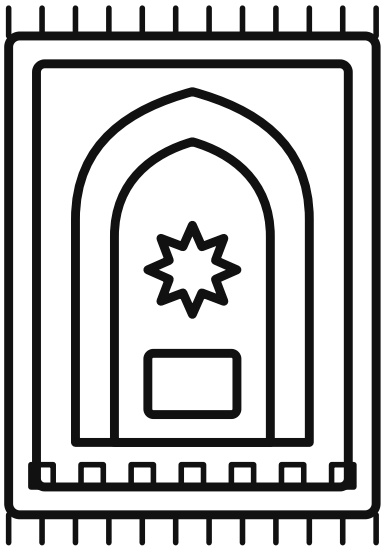
't' (or 'h') — only at the end of words from Arabic

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

End of a word: ة · after a joining letter ـة

It is only found at the end of a word.

Find ة at the end of صلاة!



ة IS FOR

صلاة

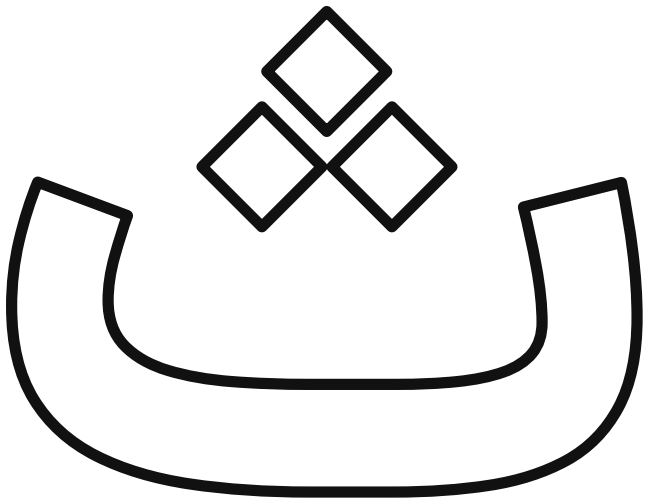
solat

prayer (salah)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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ثا

sa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

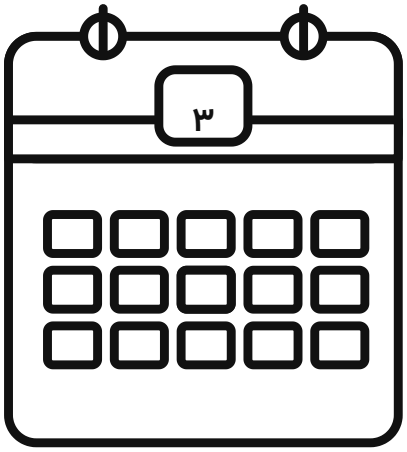
‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ثـ ـثـ ـث

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ث IS FOR

ثلاث

Selasa

Tuesday — the third day of the week

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ثـ ثـ ثـ ثـ

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ج

NAME · نام

جيم

jim

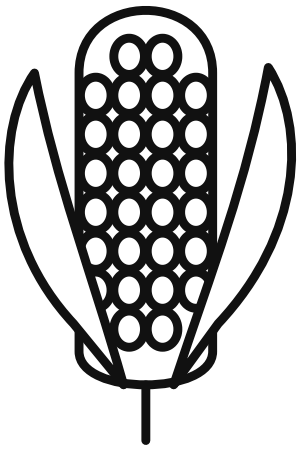
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

جـ ـجـ ـج

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ج IS FOR

جاگوڠ

jagung

corn (maize)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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ḥa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

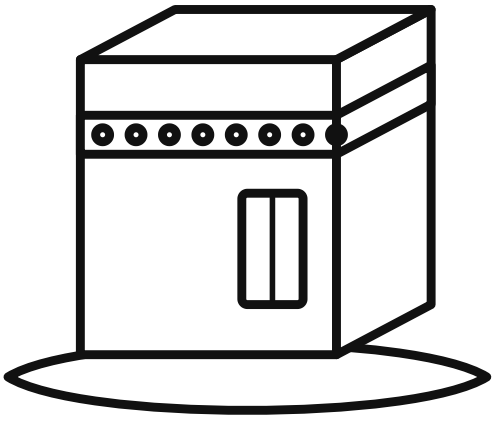
a strong breathy ‘h’ from the middle of the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ح ـحـ ـح

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ح IS FOR

حاجي

haji

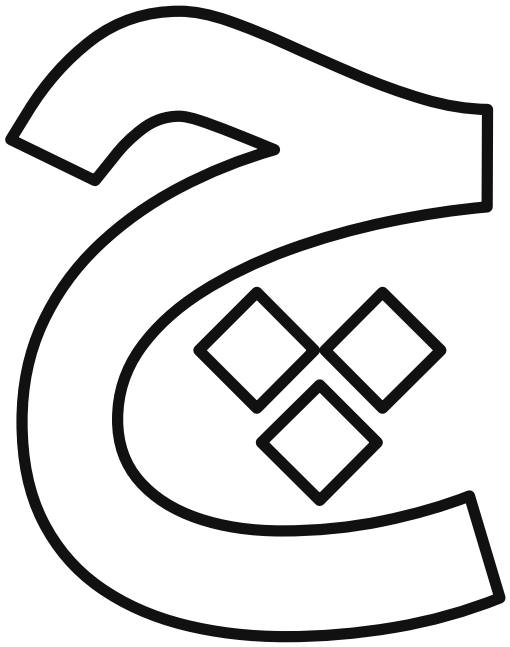
Hajj, the journey to the Kaaba in Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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NAME · نام

چا

ca

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair” — written **c** in Rumi

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

چ ـچـ ـچ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A Jawi letter: Arabic has no letter for this sound.



چ IS FOR

چاون

cawan

cup

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

چ چ چ چ

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خ

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خا

kha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

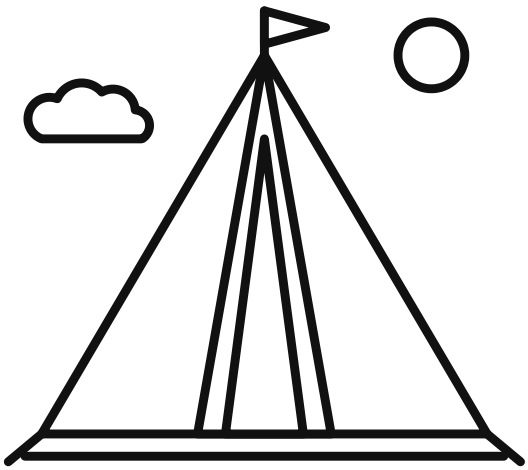
a scratchy ‘kh’ from the back of the throat, as in Scottish “loch”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

خـ ـخـ ـخ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



خ IS FOR

خيمه

khemah

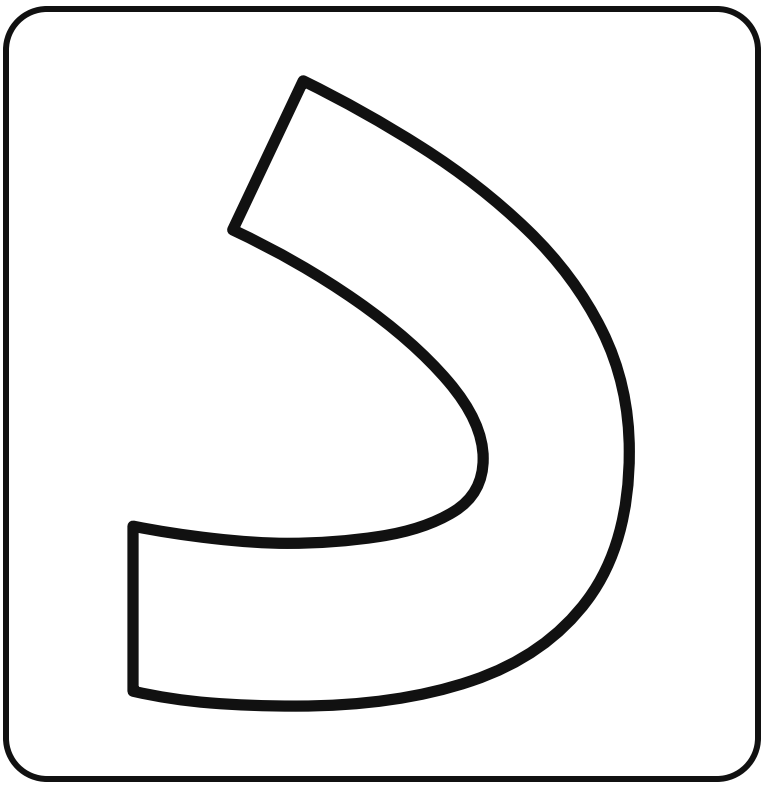
tent

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

خ خ خ خ

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NAME · نام

دال

dal

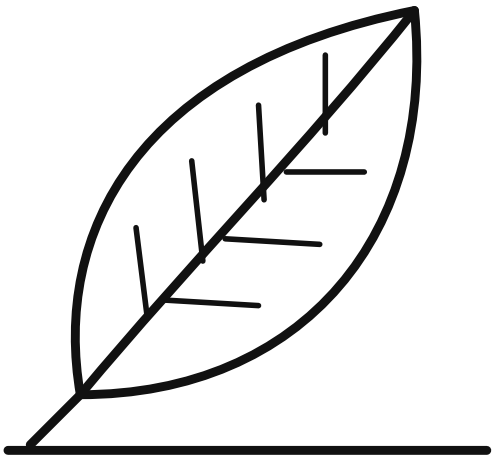
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone د · after a letter ـد

It never joins to the letter after it.



د IS FOR

داون

daun

leaf

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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zal

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

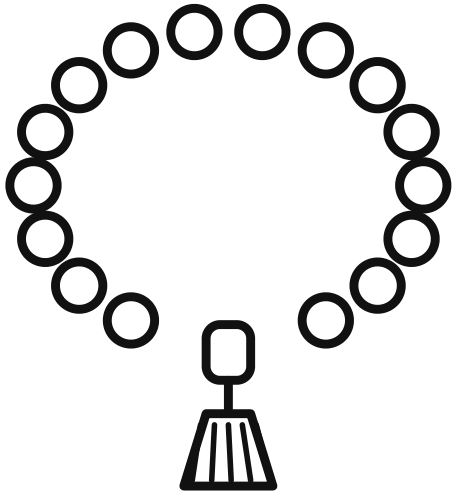
‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ذ · after a letter ـذ

It never joins to the letter after it.

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ذ IS FOR

ذكير

zikir

dhikr — remembering Allah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

ذ ذ ذ ذ

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ر

NAME · نام

را

ra

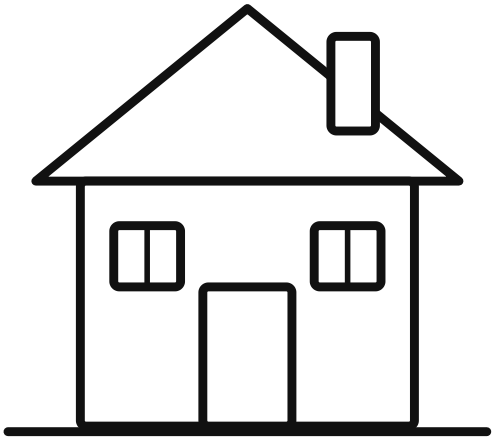
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a rolled or tapped ‘r’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ر · after a letter ـر

It never joins to the letter after it.



ر IS FOR

رومه

rumah

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ر ر ر ر

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ز

NAME · نام

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zai

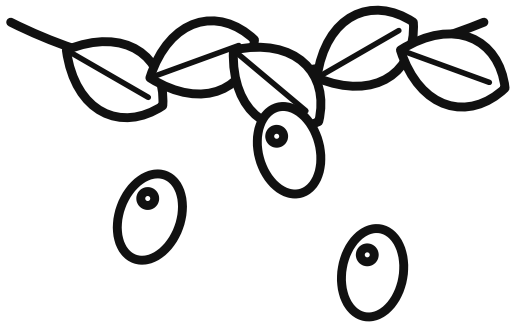
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **ز** · after a letter **ـز**

It never joins to the letter after it.



ز IS FOR

زيتون

zaitun

olives

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

ز ز ز ز

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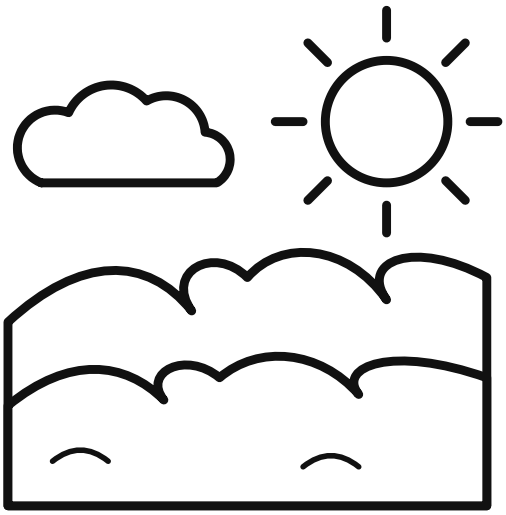
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

سـ ـسـ ـس

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



س IS FOR

سوڠاي

sungai

river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

س س س س

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ش

NAME · نام

شين

syin

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “shoe” — written **sy** in Rumi

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

شـ ـشـ ـش

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ش IS FOR

شوال

Syawal

Syawal, the month of Eid (Hari Raya)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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ص

NAME · نام

صاد

sad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

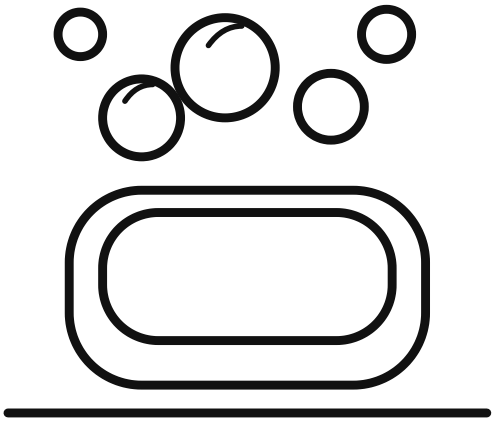
‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

صـ ـصـ ـص

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ص IS FOR

صابون

sabun

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ص ص ص ص

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ض

NAME · نام

ضاد

dad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog” (in Arabic, a heavy ‘ḍ’)

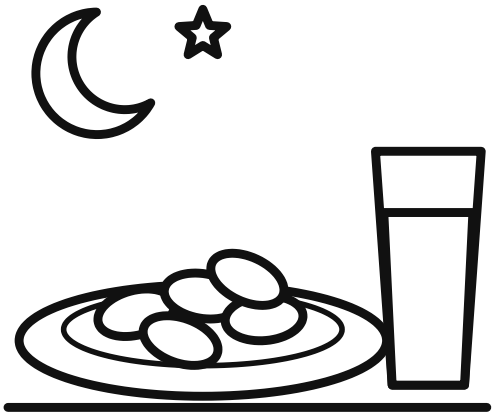
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ضـ ـضـ ـض

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.

Find ض near the end of رمضان.



ض IS FOR

رمضان

Ramadan

Ramadan, the month of fasting

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ض ض ض ض ض

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ط

NAME · نام

طا

ṭa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top” (in Arabic, a heavy ‘ṭ’)

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ط ـطـ ـط

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ط IS FOR

طهارة

taharah

taharah — washing to be clean for prayer

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

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ظ

NAME · نام

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ẓa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

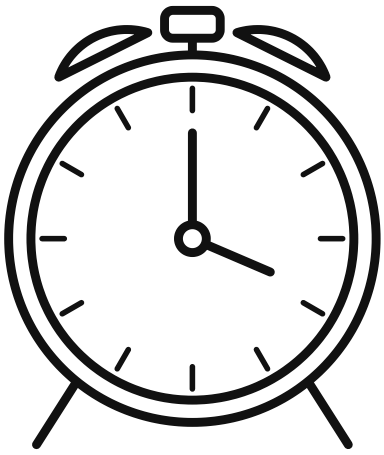
‘z’ as in “zoo” (in Arabic, a heavy ‘ẓ’)

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ظـ ـظـ ـظ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ظ IS FOR

ظهر

Zohor

Zuhr — the time of the midday prayer

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ظ ظ ظ ظ

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ع

NAME · نام

عين

ain

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

in Malay, just the vowel next to it — in Arabic, a sound from deep in the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

عـ ـعـ ـع

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



ع IS FOR

علمو

ilmu

knowledge, learning

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ع ع ع ع

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غ

NAME · نام

غين

ghain

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft gargled ‘gh’ from the back of the throat

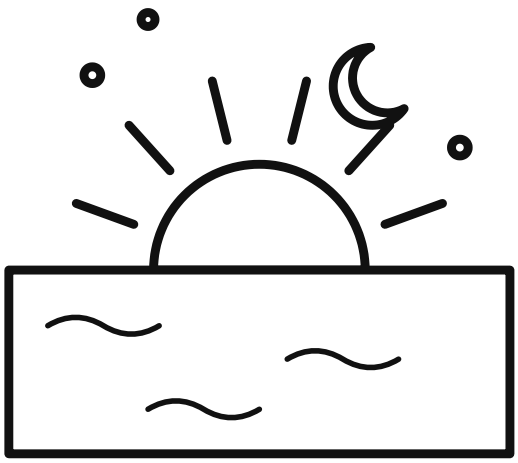
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

غـ ـغـ ـغ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.

Find غ in the middle of مغرب.



غ IS FOR

مغرب

Maghrib

sunset — the time of the evening prayer

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

غ غ غ غ

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غ

NAME · نام

غا

nga

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ng’ as in “sing” — written **ng** in Rumi

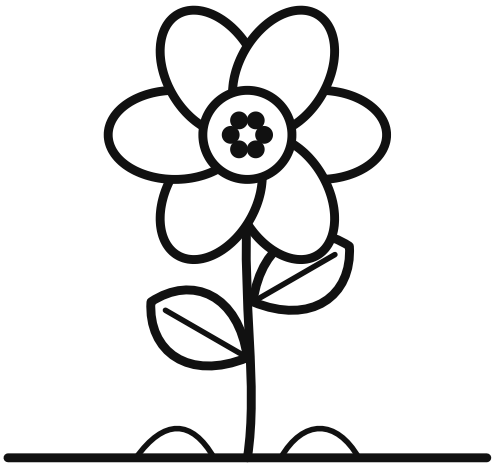
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

غـ ـغـ ـغ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A Jawi letter: Arabic has no letter for this sound. Three dots above ع.

Find غ in the middle of بوغا!



غ IS FOR

بوغا

bunga

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

غ غ غ غ

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ف

NAME · نام

فا

fa

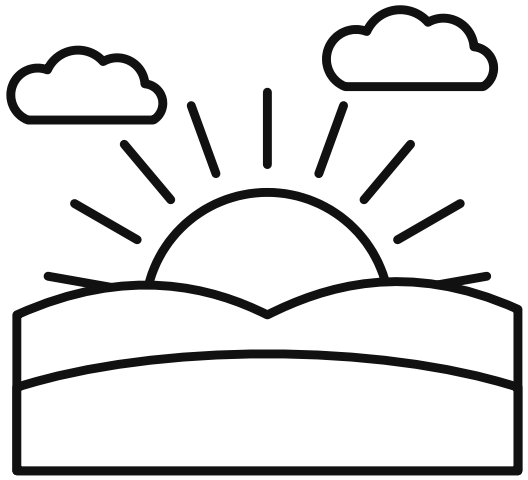
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

فـ ـفـ ـف

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ف IS FOR

فجر

fajar

dawn

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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ڤ

NAME · نام

ڤا

pa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

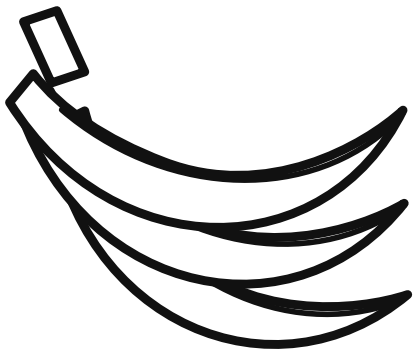
‘p’ as in “pen”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ڤ ـڤـ ـڤ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A Jawi letter: Arabic has no letter for this sound. Three dots above ف.



ڤ IS FOR

ڤيسڠ

pisang

banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

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ق

NAME · نام

قاف

qaf

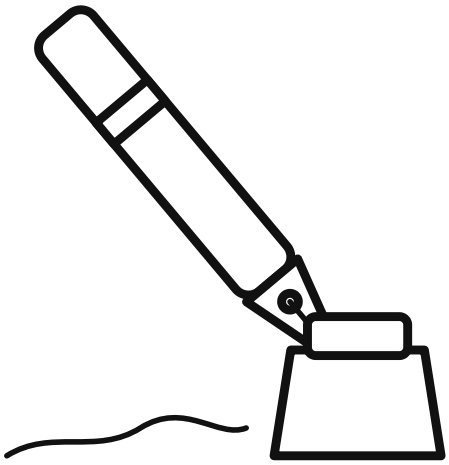
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ said far back in the throat (in Malay, often just ‘k’)

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

قـ ـقـ ـق

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ق IS FOR

قلم

kalam

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ق ق ق ق

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ک

NAME · نام

كاف

kaf

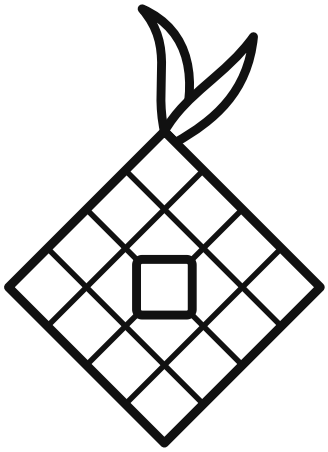
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ک ـکـ ـک

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ک IS FOR

كتوڤت

ketupat

ketupat — rice cooked in a woven palm-leaf case for Hari Raya

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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ڬ

NAME · نام

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ga

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

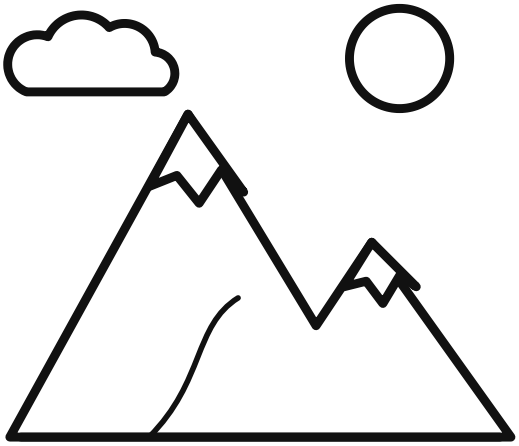
‘g’ as in “go”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ڬ ـڬـ ـڬ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A Jawi letter: Arabic has no letter for this sound. One dot above ک.



ڬ IS FOR

ڬونوڠ

gunung

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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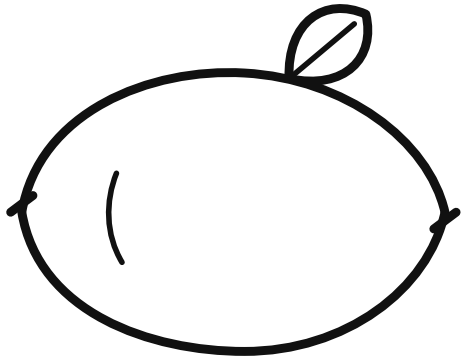
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ل ـلـ ـل

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ل IS FOR

ليماو

limau

lime, citrus fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

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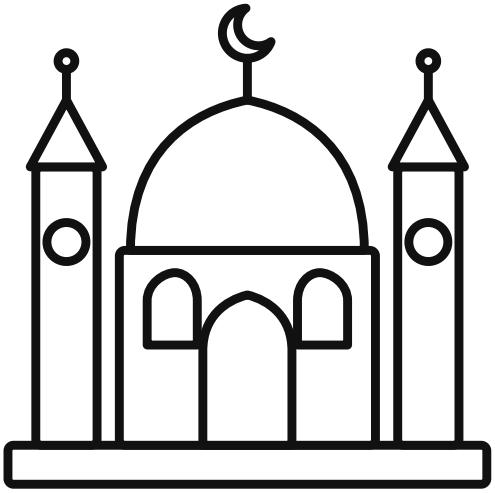
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

مـ ـمـ ـم

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



م IS FOR

مسجد

masjid

mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

م م م م

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ن

NAME · نام

نون

nun

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

نـ ـنـ ـن

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ن IS FOR

ناسي

nasi

cooked rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

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و

NAME · نام

واو

wau

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

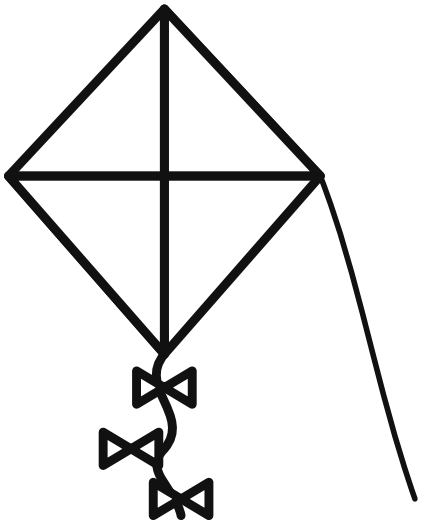
'w' as in "water", or the vowels 'u' and 'o'

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **و** · after a letter **ـو**

It never joins to the letter after it.

The letter's name and the word sound the same!



و IS FOR

واو

wau

wau — a big Malay kite

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

و و و و

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ڤ

NAME · نام

ڤا

va

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

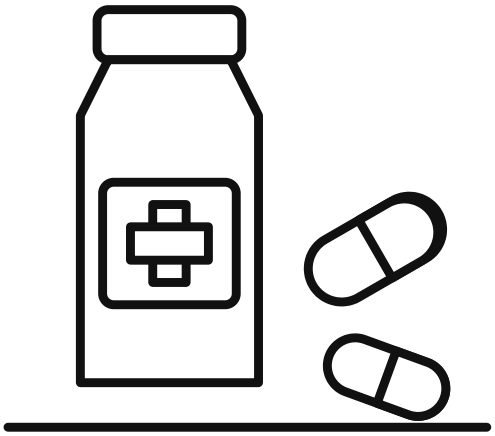
'v' as in "van" — only in borrowed words

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **ڤ** · after a letter **ـڤ**

It never joins to the letter after it.

A Jawi letter: Arabic has no letter for this sound. One dot above و.



ڤ IS FOR

ڤيتامين

vitamin

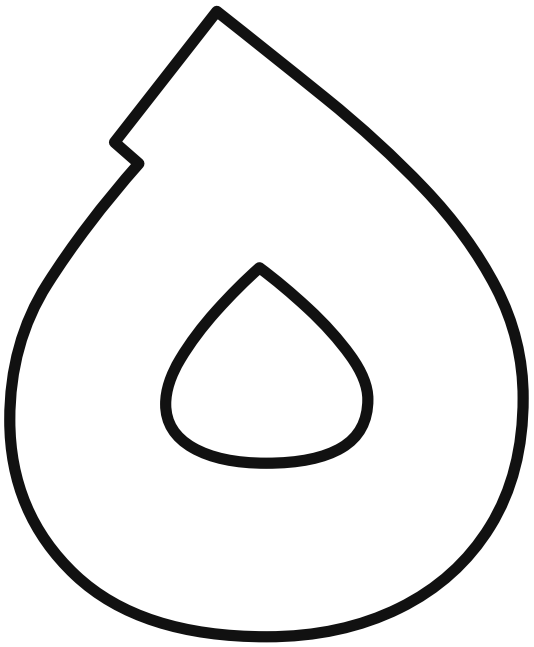
vitamins

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ڤ ڤ ڤ ڤ

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NAME · نام

ها

ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

هـ ـهـ ـه

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ه IS FOR

هوجن

hujan

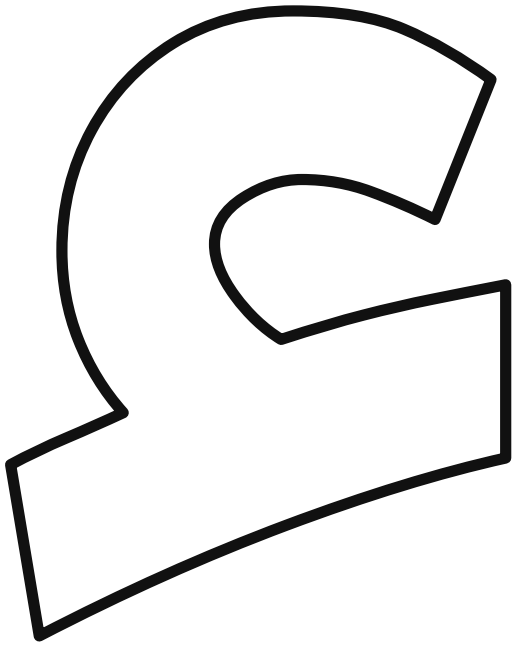
rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ه ه ه ه

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NAME · نام

همزه

hamzah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

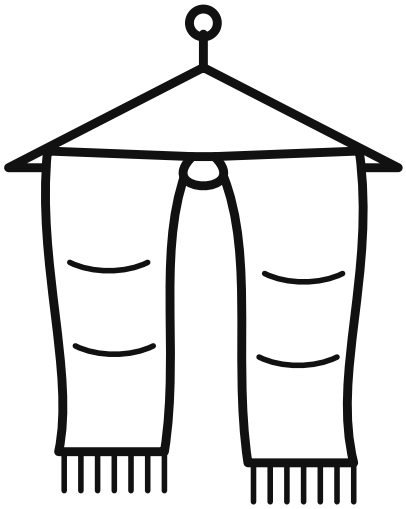
a tiny break in the voice between two vowels

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Always alone: **ع**

It never joins to any letter. It sits on the line between two vowels.

Find the ء between the two vowels of كاءين *ka-in*.



ء IS FOR

كاءين

kain

cloth

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ع ع ع ع

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ي

NAME · نام

يا

ya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”, or the vowels ‘i’ and ‘e’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

يـ ـيـ ـي

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Find ي in the middle of ڤايوڠ.



ي IS FOR

ڤايوڠ

payung

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

ي ي ي ي

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ى

NAME · نام

اليف مقصورة

alif maksurah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'a' — only at the end of some words from Arabic

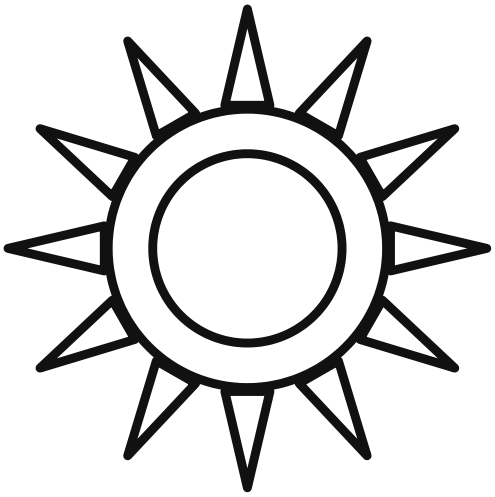
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

End of a word: **ى** · after a joining letter **ـى**

It is only found at the end of a word.

It looks like ي without its dots.

Find ى at the end of ضحى!



ى IS FOR

ضحى

Duha

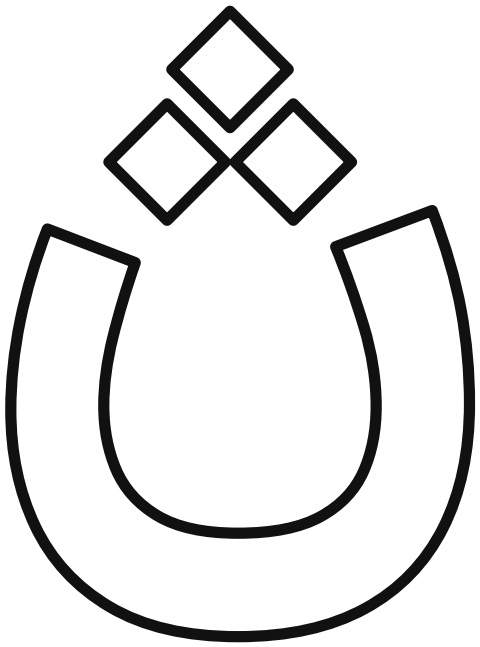
Duha — the bright late-morning time

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس

ى ى ى ى

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NAME · نام

ڽا

nya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

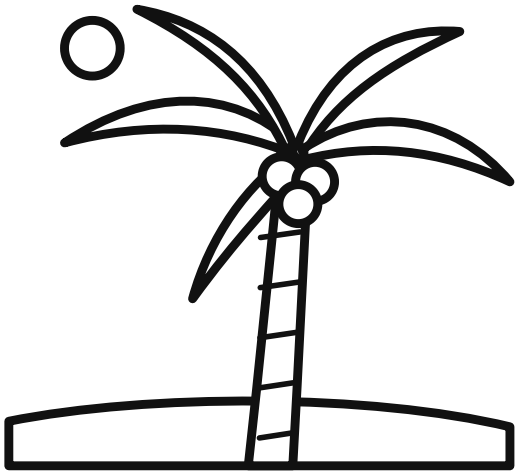
‘ny’ as in “canyon” — written **ny** in Rumi

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ڽ ـڽـ ـڽ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A Jawi letter: Arabic has no letter for this sound. Three dots below.



ڽ IS FOR

ڽيور

nyiur

coconut palm

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس

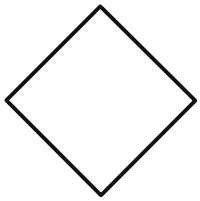
ڽ ڽ ڽ ڽ

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BONUS

Malay numbers نومبور *(nombor)*

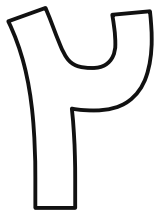
Color the numbers and count out loud in Malay: *sifar*, *satu*, *dua*, *tiga*...



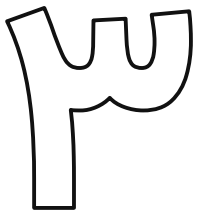
0
سيفر
sifar
zero



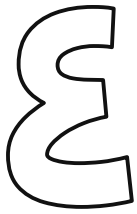
1
ساتو
satu
one



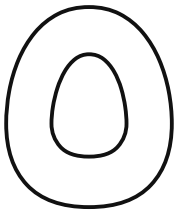
2
دوا
dua
two



3
تيڬ
tiga
three



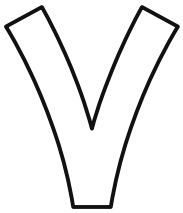
4
امڤت
empat
four



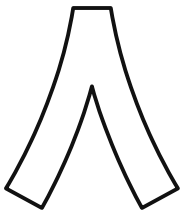
5
ليم
lima
five



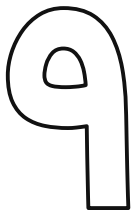
6
انم
enam
six



7
توجوه
tujuh
seven



8
لاڤن
lapan
eight



9
سمبيلن
sembilan
nine

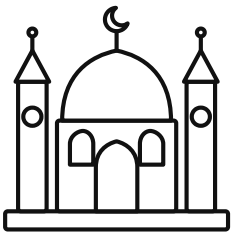
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LET'S TALK

My first Malay words ڤرکاتاءن ڤرتام

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

السلام عليكم	*assalamualaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
وعليكم السلام	*waalaikumussalam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
نام ساي ...	*nama saya ...* **My name is ...**
تريما كاسيه	*terima kasih* **Thank you**
جزاک الله خيرا	*jazakallahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
ايبو · باڤ	*ibu · bapa* **Mother · Father**
ابڠ · كاكق	*abang · kakak* **(Older) brother · (older) sister**
ي · تيدق	*ya · tidak* **Yes · No**
ساي سدڠ بلاجر بهاس ملايو!	*saya sedang belajar bahasa Melayu!* **I am learning Malay!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

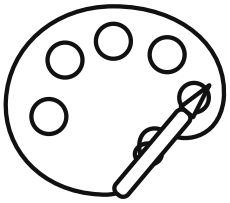
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **37 Malay letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Malay, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ماشاءالله! باگوس!

masya-Allah! bagus! — Well done, very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 37 letters of the Malay alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

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